

MODULE 4

Distribution and Promotion: Roles and purpose of Marketing Channels, Factors Affecting Channel Choice, Channel Design, Channel Management Decision, Channel Conflict, Designing a physical Distribution System. Promotions- Marketing communications- Integrated Marketing Communications (IMC)-communication objectives, steps in developing effective communication. Advertising: Advertising Objectives, Advertising Budget, Advertising Copy, AIDA model, Traditional Vs Modern Media- Online and Mobile Advertising, social media for Advertising. Push-pull strategies of promotion.

MARKETING CHANNELS MEANING

- A marketing channel is the people, organizations, and activities necessary to transfer the ownership of goods from the point of production to the point of consumption. It is the way products get to the end-user, the consumer; and is also known as a distribution channel. A marketing channel is a useful tool for management and is crucial to creating an effective and well-planned marketing strategy
- Creating a customer is a major task of marketing but delivering the goods to the customer so created is the most critical task. Physical distribution is a marketing activity that concerns the handling and the movement of goods. It is a major component of marketing mix and cost area of business.
- It involves the coordination of activities to place the right quantity of right goods at the desired Place and time. Like any other marketing mix component, physical distribution has two broad objectives to attain, namely, consumer satisfaction and profit maximization. Physical distribution is not only a cost but a powerful tool of competitive marketing.
- A channel of distribution is an organized network or system of agencies and institutions, which, in combination, perform all the activities required to link producers with users and users with producers to accomplish the marketing task.

MARKETING CHANNELS DEFINITION

- **According to Phillip Kotler,**” It is a set of independent organizations involved in the process of making a product or service available for use or consumption.” Thus, a channel of distribution is a path way directing the flow of goods and services from producers to consumers composed of intermediaries through their functions and attainment of the mutual objectives.

- **In the words of Phillip Kotler**, “Physical distribution involves planning, implementing and controlling the physical flow of materials, and final goods from the point of origin of use to meet customer needs at a profit.”

PURPOSE OF MARKETING CHANNELS

- **To ensure the proper availability of desired products**
The major purpose of any distribution channel is to provide the desired product at the desired marketplace. For this, organization first identify the relevant market place having significant demand for the concerned products.
- **To improve the sales outlook**
In a particular retail store the sale of organizational products depends on its display. The purpose of distribution channels is to arrange a proper display of organizational products in the retail store so that the sales outlook of that particular retail store as well as organization can be improved.
- **To establish cooperation between distribution factors**
Various factors affect the distributors system like, type of unit loads, delivery time limits, order size, delivery access, handling aids or tools, nature of product handling etc. a strong cooperation between these factors is required for efficient distribution.
- **To achieve and maintain a level of service**
Another purpose of distribution channels is to achieve and maintain a level of service towards both customers and suppliers. This is important for the customers. They observe the services performance of different suppliers so as to compare them and to determine the future purchase decisions.
- **To minimize logistics and total cost**
Cost of production is included in the price of a given product. This cost is very important for pricing. Therefore, distribution channels of an organization are focused to minimize the logistics and total cost of the product. A particular cost reflected by selected distribution channel must be evaluated in terms of type of product served and the required service level.
- **To collect accurate information**
Another purpose of distribution channels is to collect accurate information. An efficient distribution system requires sound flow of information. Sales trends, cost monitoring, service levels, damage reports, inventory levels etc are helpful in getting required information.

LEVELS OF CHANNELS

This indicates the number of intermediaries between the manufactures and consumers. Mainly there are four channel levels. They are

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1.**Zero level channel:** - Here the goods move directly from producer to consumer. That is, no intermediary is involved. This channel is preferred by manufactures of industrial and consumer durable goods

2.**One level channel:** In this case there will be one sales intermediary ie, retailer. This is the most common channel in case of consumer durable such as textiles, shoes, ready garments etc.

3.**Two level channel:** This channel option has two intermediaries, namely wholesaler and retailer. The companies producing consumer non durable items use this level.

4.**Three level channel:** This contains three intermediaries. Here goods move from manufacture to agent to wholesalers to retailers to consumers. It is the longest indirect channel option that a company has.

CHANNELS AVAILABLE FOR THE DISTRIBUTION OF CONSUMER GOODS.

Channels typically depends on the nature of the product, the target market, and the objectives of the company. Here are some of the most common channels:

1. Direct distribution: In this channel, the manufacturer sells the products directly to the end consumer. This can be done through a company-owned website, a retail store, or even door-to-door sales.
2. Retail distribution: This channel involves selling products through a network of retail stores. Retailers purchase products from the manufacturer or wholesaler and sell them to the end consumer. Examples include department stores, supermarkets, and specialty stores.
3. Wholesale distribution: In this channel, the manufacturer sells the products to wholesalers, who then sell the products to retailers. This is a common channel for products that are sold in bulk, such as food and beverages.
4. Online distribution: This channel involves selling products online through a company-owned website or through third-party e-commerce platforms like Amazon or eBay.
5. Direct mail distribution: This channel involves sending catalogs or other promotional materials directly to consumers through the mail. Consumers can then place orders through the mail, phone, or online.
6. Multi-level marketing: This channel involves selling products through a network of independent distributors. The distributors earn a commission on the products they sell, as well as on the sales made by the distributors they recruit.

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7. Direct response distribution: In this channel, the manufacturer or distributor sells products through infomercials, television ads, or other forms of direct marketing. Consumers can place orders by phone or online.

FACTORS AFFECTING CHANNEL CHOICE

Factors Pertaining to the Product:

Keeping in view the nature, qualities and peculiarities of the product, could only the channel for distribution be properly made. The following factors concerning the product, affect the selection of the channel of distribution:

1. **Price of the Product**: The products of a lower price have a long chain of distributors. As against it, the products having higher price have a smaller chain. Very often, the producer himself has to sell the products to the consumers directly.
2. **Perishability**: The products which are of a perishable nature need lesser number of the intermediaries or agents for their sale. Under this very rule, most of the eatables (food items), and the bakery items are distributed only by the retail sellers.
3. **Size and Weight**: The size and weight of the products too affect the selection of the middlemen. Generally, heavy industrial goods are distributed by the producers themselves to the industrial consumers.
4. **Technical Nature**: Some products are of the nature that prior to their selling, the consumer is required to be given proper instructions with regard to its consumption. In such a case less of the middlemen are required to be used.
5. **Goods Made to Order**: The products that are manufactured as per the orders of the customers could be sold directly and the standardized items could be sold off only by the middlemen.
6. **After-Sales Service**: The products regarding which the after-sales service is to be provided could be sold off either personally or through the authorized agents.

Factors pertaining to the Consumer or Market:

The following are the main elements concerned with the consumer or the market:

1. **Number of Customers**: If the number of customers is large, definitely the services of the middlemen will have to be sought for. As against it, the products whose customers are

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less in number are distributed by the manufacturer himself.

2. **Expansion of the Consumers:** The span over which are the customers of any commodity spread over, also affects the selection of the channel of distribution. When the consumers are spread through a small or limited sphere, the product is distributed by the producer himself or his agent. As against it, the goods whose distributors are spread throughout the whole country, for such distributors, services of wholesaler and the retailer are sought.
3. **Size of the Order:** When bulk supply orders are received from the consumers, the producer himself takes up the responsibility for the supply of these goods. If the orders are received piece-meal or in smaller quantities, for it the services of the wholesaler could be sought. In this way, the size of the order also influences the selection of the channel of the distribution.
4. **Objective of Purchase:** If the product is being purchased for the industrial use; its direct sale is proper or justified. As against it, if the products are being purchased for the general consumption, the products reach the consumers after passing innumerable hands.
5. **Need of the Credit Facilities:** If, for the sale of any product, it becomes necessary to grant credit to any customer, it shall be helpful for the producer that for its distribution, the services of the wholesaler and retailer businessmen be sought. In this way, the need of the credit facilities too influences the selection of the channel of distribution.

C. Factors Pertaining to the Middlemen:

The following are the main factors concerned with the middlemen:

1. **Services Provided by Middlemen:** The selection of the middlemen is made keeping in view their services. If some product is quite new and there is the need of its publicity and promotion of sales, then instead of adopting the agency system, the work must be entrusted to the representatives.
2. **Scope or Possibilities of Quantity of Sales:** The same channel should be selected by means of which there is the possibility of more sales.
3. **Attitude of Agents towards the Producers' Policies:** The producers generally prefer to select such middlemen who go by their policies. Very often when the distribution and supply policies of the producers being disliked by the middlemen, the selection of middlemen becomes quite limited.

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4. **Cost of Channel of Distribution:** While selecting the channel of distribution, the cost of distribution and the services provided by the middlemen or agents too must be kept into consideration. The producers generally select the most economical channel.

D. Factors Pertaining to the Producer or Company:

The following factors, concerning the producer, affect the selection of the channel of distribution:

1. **Level of Production:** The manufacturers who are financially sound and are of a larger category, are able to appoint the sales representatives in a larger number and thus could distribute the commodities (products) in larger quantities. As against it, for the smaller manufacturers, it becomes necessary to procure the services of the wholesalers and the retail traders.
2. **Financial Resources of the Company:** From the financial point of view, the stronger company needs less middlemen.
3. **Managerial Competence and Experience:** If some producer lacks in the necessary managerial experience or proficiency, he will depend more upon the middlemen. The new manufacturers in the beginning remain more dependent upon the middlemen.

E. Other Factors:

1. **Distribution Channel of Competitors:** While determining the channel of distribution, the channels of distribution of the competitors too must be borne in mind.
2. **Social Viewpoint:** What is the attitude of society towards the distribution, this fact too must be kept into consideration while selecting the middlemen.
3. **Freedom of Altering:** While selecting the agents, this fact too must be kept into mind that in case of need, there must be the liberty of changing or replacing the agents (middlemen).

CHANNEL DESIGN

Channel design: Those decisions involving the development of new marketing channels where none had existed before, or the modification of existing channels.

Channel design is presented as a decision faced by the marketer, and it includes either setting up channels from scratch or modifying existing channels. This is sometimes referred to as reengineering the channel and in practice is more common than setting up channels from scratch.

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The term design implies that the marketer is consciously and actively allocating the distribution tasks to develop an efficient channel, and the term selection means the actual selection of channel members.



1. **Defining the customer needs** - In designing the market channel, the marketer must understand the service output levels its target customer want. It is essential to capture customer requirements while designing marketing channel.

It includes the following:

- Product information
- Product customization
- Product quality assurance
- Lot size
- Product variety
- Spatial convenience / availability
- Waiting and delivery time
- After sales service
- Logistics

When a marketer designs a marketing channel, he must understand the service output levels desired by the target customers. Different customers have different levels of service requirements. A high potential customer needs to be offered effective and professional service backup, ensured availability of varied products compared to the low potential customer. The marketing channel designer has to know at this stage itself that providing superior service output means increased channel costs and higher prices for customers.

2. **Defining the channel objective** - The channel objective vary with product characteristics:

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- Perishable products require more direct marketing.
- Bulky products, such as building materials, require channels that minimize the shipping distance and amount of handling
- Non- standard products, such as custom-built machinery and specialized business forms, are sold directly by company sales representatives.
- High- unit- value products such as generators and turbines are often sold through a company sales force rather than intermediaries.

Channel objectives are a part of and result from the company's marketing objectives that need to be stated in terms of targeted service output levels. Profit considerations and asset utilization must be reflected in channel objectives and the resultant design. It should be the endeavor of the channel members to minimize the total channel costs and still provide with the desired level of service outputs. Channel objectives keep varying depending on the characteristics of the products. For example, while a customized non-standard product requires company sales force to sell directly, products like HVAC (Heating, Ventilation and Air-conditioning) are either sold by the company or its franchised dealers.

3. **Channel Alternative** - A company looks at alternatives for its distribution channel after it has decided on the targeted customers and the customer service deliverables it desires from its channel partners to reach these customers. At the time of deciding the company will scan for:

Type of intermediaries

- Distributors or re-distribution stock list
- Carrying and forwarding agents
- Logistics service providers.
- Manufacturer's agents, stock list, guarantors
- Financing agencies
- Wholesalers and semi wholesalers
- Retailers and service centers

4. **Evaluation of Major Alternative** - The major problem before the producer is to decide which of the alternatives would be best satisfy the long term objectives of the firm taking in view the factors which would affect the channel decision. For this purpose, each alternative must be rated against economic; control and adequate criteria

There are several channel alternatives available to the industrial markets. They have to determine the best among the alternatives by evaluating them based on the following criteria:

1. Economic Performance
2. Degree of control

3. Degree of adaptability of channel members
5. **Ideal Channel Structure** - With the completion of forgoing steps, the number of alternatives would have narrowed down considerably. The firm must evaluate design and choose the best among them.

CHANNEL MANAGEMENT DECISIONS

The term Channel Management is widely used in sales marketing parlance. It is defined as a process where the company develops various marketing techniques as well as sales strategies to reach the widest possible customer base. The channels are nothing but ways or outlets to market and sell products. The ultimate aim of any organization is to develop a better relationship between the customer and the product.

Channel management helps in developing a program for selling and servicing customers within a specific channel. The aim is to streamline communication between a business and the customer. To do this, you need to segment your channels according to the characteristics of your customers: their needs, buying patterns, success factors, etc. and then customize a program that includes goals, policies, products, sales, and marketing program (1). The goal of channel management is to establish direct communication with customers in each channel. If the company is able to effectively achieve this goal, the management will have a better idea which marketing channel best suits that particular customer base. The techniques used in each channel could be different, but the overall strategy must always brand the business consistently throughout the communication

A business must determine what it wants out of each channel and also clearly define the framework for each of those channels to produce desired results. Identifying the segment of the population linked to each channel also helps to determine the best products to pitch to those channels.

Steps in channel management decision

1. Selecting channel members
2. Training channel partners
3. Motivating channel members
4. Evaluating channel members
5. Modifying channel arrangements

CHANNEL CONFLICT

Meaning - Channel conflict occurs when manufacturers (brands) dis-intermediate their channel partners, such as distributors, retailers, dealers, and sales representatives, by selling their products directly to consumers through general marketing methods and/or over the Internet.

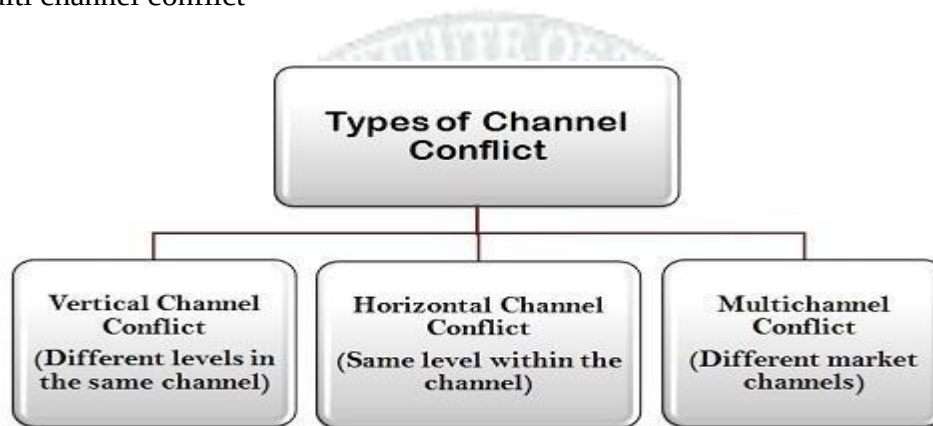
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Refers to a Situation when a producer or supplier bypasses the normal channel of distribution and sells directly to the end user. Selling over the internet while maintaining a physical distribution network is an example of channel conflict. See also disintermediation.

The Channel Conflict arises when the channel partners such as manufacturer, wholesaler, distributor, retailer, etc. compete against each other for the common sale with the same brand.

TYPES OF CHANNEL CONFLICT

1. Vertical channel conflict
2. Horizontal channel conflict
3. Multi channel conflict



1. **Vertical Channel Conflict:** This type of conflict arises between the different levels in the same channel.
E.g. The conflict between the manufacturer and the wholesaler regarding price, quantity, marketing activities, etc.
2. **Horizontal Channel Conflict:** This type of conflict arises between the same level in the same channel.
E.g. The conflict between two retailers of the same manufacturer faces disparity in terms of sales target, area coverage, promotional schemes, etc.
3. **Multichannel Conflict:** This type of conflict arises between the different market channels participating in the common sale for the same brand.
E.g. If a manufacturer uses two market channels, first is the official website through which the products and services are sold. The second channel is the traditional channel i.e. through wholesaler and retailer. If the product is available at a much lower price on a website than is available with the retailer, the multichannel conflict arises.

CAUSES OF CHANNEL CONFLICT

- ☐ **Goal incompatibility:** Different partners in the channel of distribution have different goals that may or may not coincide with each other and thus result in conflict.
E.g. The manufacturer wants to achieve the larger market share by adopting the market penetration strategy i.e. offering a product at low price and making the profits in the long run, whereas the dealer wants to sell the product at a high cost i.e. market skimming strategy and earn huge profits in the short run.
- ☐ **Ambiguous Roles:** The channel partners may not have a clear picture of their role i.e. what they are supposed to do, which market to cater, what pricing strategy is to be adopted, etc.
E.g. The manufacturer may sell its products through its direct sales force in the same area where the authorized dealer is supposed to sell; this may result in the conflict.
- ☐ **Different Perceptions:** The channel partners may have different perceptions about the market conditions that hamper the business as a whole thereby leading to the conflict.
E.g. The manufacturer is optimistic about the change in the price of the product whereas the dealer feels the negative impact of price change on the customers.
- ☐ **Manufacturer dominating the Intermediaries:** The intermediaries such as the wholesaler, distributor, retailer, etc. carry the process of distribution of goods and services for the manufacturer. And if the manufacturer makes any change in the price, product, marketing activity the same has to be implemented with an immediate effect thereby reflecting the huge dependence of intermediaries on the manufacturer.
E.g. If the manufacturer changes the promotional scheme of a product with the intention to cut the cost, the retailer may find it difficult to sell the product without any promotional scheme and hence the conflict arises.
- ☐ **Lack of Communication:** This is one of the major reasons that lead to the conflict among the channel partners. If any partner is not communicated about any changes on time will hamper the distribution process and will result in disparity.
E.g. If retailer urgently requires the stock and the wholesaler didn't inform him about the availability of time may lead to the conflict between the two.

MANAGING CHANNEL CONFLICT

- ☐ **Subordinate Goals:** The channel partners must decide a single goal in terms of increased market share, survival, profit maximization, high quality, customer satisfaction, etc. with the intention to avoid conflicts.
- ☐ **Exchanging employees:** one of the best ways to escape channel conflict is to swap employees between different levels i.e. two or more persons can shift to a dealer level from the

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manufacturer level and from wholesale level to the retailer level on a temporary basis. By doing so, everyone understands the role and operations of each other thereby reducing the role ambiguities.

□ Trade associations: Another way to overcome the channel conflict is to form the association between the channel partners. This can be done through joint membership among the intermediaries. Every channel partner works as one entity and works unanimously.

□ Co-optation: Under this, any leader or an expert in another organization is included in the advisory committee, board of directors, or grievance redressal committees to reduce the conflicts through their expert opinions.

□ Diplomacy, Mediation and Arbitration: when the conflict becomes critical then partners have to resort to one of these methods.

- ❖ In Diplomacy, the partners in the conflict send one person from each side to resolve the conflict.

- ❖ In Mediation, the third person is involved who tries to resolve the conflict through his skills of conciliation.

- ❖ In Arbitration, when both the parties agree to present their arguments to the arbitrator and agree to his decision.

□ Legal resource: When the conflict becomes crucial and cannot be resolved through any above mentioned ways, the channel partners may decide to file a lawsuit.

DESIGNING A PHYSICAL DISTRIBUTION SYSTEM

Meaning - Physical distribution is the group of activities associated with the supply of finished product from the production line to the consumers. The physical distribution considers many sales distribution channels, such as wholesale and retail, and includes critical decision areas like customer service, inventory, materials, packaging, order processing, and transportation and logistics.

The planning, implementation, and controlling of the physical flow of material or product from one point to another to meet the customer requirements in the market is known as physical distribution.

Physical distribution is responsible for delivering to the customer what is wanted on time and at minimum cost. The objective of distribution management is to design and operate a distribution a system that attains the required level of customer service and does so at least cost. To reach this

Objective, all activities involved in the movement and storage of goods must be organized into an integrated system (physically).

Steps in Designing a Physical Distribution System

To design a physical distribution system for a product, following steps need to be followed –

- Step 1 – Defining distribution objective and services required for product distribution
- Step 2 – Articulating customer requirement
- Step 3 – Comparing the strategy with market competitors
- Step 4 – Managing the cost of distribution to decrease cost without compromising on the quality of service
- Step 5 – Building physical distribution system that is flexible for implementation of changes, if required

COMPONENTS/ ELEMENTS OF A PHYSICAL DISTRIBUTION SYSTEM

Physical distribution can be controlled and monitored by its different components. Each component should be evaluated and managed in order to accomplish physical distribution without any problems.

The various elements of a physical distribution system are:

1. Customer service:

Customer service is a predefined standard of customer satisfaction, which a retailer plans to provide to its customers. Without defining and setting ‘standards of customer service’, retailers cannot achieve competitive advantage over their competitors. A customer service standard may be that 95% of the orders are delivered within 5 hours of receipt and 100% are delivered within 24 hours. Retailers maintaining higher service standards bear costs of maintaining higher inventory level or expenditure incurred on fast mode of transportation.

The effective distribution systems must keep proper records of costs of meeting various customer service standards (90%, 95% or 100% of orders delivered within 24 hours), and additional customer satisfaction that results from raising standards.

These days, specialized software packages are being used by modern retailers to track the merchandise during its transportation to ensure fastest, cost-effective deliveries on time.

Customer service levels may be improved by following steps too:

- (a) By ensuring product availability all the time.
- (b) By improving order cycle time – it implies reducing the gap between placing the order and its delivery time.
- (c) By providing proper training to sales persons and employees engaged in transportation.
- (d) By having separate plans for
 - ❖ quick deliveries in case of urgent orders
 - ❖ in case of natural/unforeseen problems

2. Order Processing:

Order processing, alternatively known as order fulfillment is the handling of customer orders within the distribution center (may be warehouse, retail store itself) involving the keying of customer and order details into the computer system in order to produce the invoices for picking. The basic idea is to deliver the orders as per customers' wants of place and timing.

Therefore, action should be taken quickly as an order has been placed and the customer must have fast confirmation of the order's receipt and the exact delivery time. In today's high tech world, computers are used to check the customer's credit rating, stock levels, and delivery promptness so that management can obtain an accurate picture of distribution status. Accuracy plays a vital role in successful order processing, as are procedures that are designed to lessen (shorten) the order processing cycle.

3. Inventory Control:

Inventory control is a major component of a retail organization's physical distribution system. It includes money invested in inventory, wear and tear and possible obsolescence of the goods with the passage of time. In a retail organization, where finance executives seek inventory minimization, marketing executives advocate large inventories to prevent stock outs. Therefore, retailers should try to minimize optimum level of inventory to meet the customers' demand close to customer service standards of 100%.

4. Warehousing:

It involves all the activities required in storage of goods between the time these are procured and the time these are transported to the customer upon receipt of order. This function basically involves receiving the merchandise, breaking bulk, storing and loading for delivery to customers as per their details. Storage warehouses usually keep goods for long periods while distribution centers operate as central/middle locations for quick movements of goods to retail stores.

Further, retail organizations use regional distribution centers where wholesalers dump the products in high volume. At regional distribution centers, these consignments are broken down to small loads that are then quickly transported to retail outlets as per the outlet's requirements.

5. Transportation Mode:

Transportation is indispensable for physical distribution of goods and services. Transportation mode enables channel members like producers, wholesalers and retailers to make goods and services available at the customers' place of purchase or at his doorstep. From cost point of view, transportation accounts nearly 25-40% of total distribution costs. Quick and timely delivery, security of goods during transit and proper handling results in customer satisfaction.

6. Materials Handling:

Materials handling implies the movement of goods inside the retail organization, warehouses and retail stores/outlets. In case of chain stores, the raw materials, finished goods etc move from a common warehouse to various store locations. Similarly, in case of multistory or even single-story storage houses, movements of goods take place.

Some items or materials may be light weight but few may be heavy, which may require proper handling and utmost care. In modern storage facilities, material handling is through equipments meant for moving/transferring goods. These handling equipments also vary with method of loading and modes of transport used like railways, water ways, airways etc.

Type of handling equipment used will depend upon the following reasons:

- ❖ Mode of transport: rail, air, water, road and others.
- ❖ Nature & size of goods (materials: heavy, light, solid, liquid or gases).
- ❖ Place of operation: warehouse & selling floor.

Other components of the physical distribution system –

- Planning of physical distribution system
- Storage planning in plant
- Logistics
- Warehousing on field
- Receiving
- Sub distribution of product
- Management of inventory at various levels
- Execution of order
- Accounting transactions
- Communication at different levels

PROMOTIONS:

- Promotion is also one of the elements in the promotional mix or promotional plan. These are personal selling, advertising, sales promotion, direct marketing, publicity, word of mouth and may also include event marketing, exhibitions and trade shows.
- A promotional plan specifies how much attention to pay to each of the elements in the promotional mix, and what proportion of the budget should be allocated to each element.

MARKETING COMMUNICATIONS:

- Marketing communication involves sharing of meaning, information and concepts by the source and the receiver about the products and services and also about the firm selling through the devices of promotion via, advertising, publicity, salesmanship and sales promotion.
- One of the primary goals of marketing communication is to persuade consumers or businesses, by either changing their perception of a brand, product, or service or persuading them to purchase (or feel motivated / tempted to purchase) a product or service.
- Marketing Communications refers to the use of different marketing channels and tools in combination. Marketing communication channels focus on how businesses communicate a message to its desired market, or the market in general. It is also in charge of the internal communications of the organization.

DIRECT MARKETING

Direct marketing is a type of marketing that involves communicating directly with customers and potential customers in order to promote products and services. Direct marketing can be conducted in various ways, including email, text messages, catalogs, phone calls, and direct mail.

Direct marketing is a form of advertising that involves directly communicating a marketing message to a potential customer, usually through mail, email, telemarketing, or door-to-door visits. Examples of direct marketing include mail order catalogs, flyers, postcards, coupons, and door-to-door sales.

INTEGRATED MARKETING COMMUNICATION – (IMC)

Integrated Marketing Communications (IMC) blends various promotional tools and communications/marketing/advertising services and techniques to maximize profit. IMC is ultimately achieved through concise and consistent messaging that fosters familiarity and consumer affinity. Effective IMC messages and images are meaningful and useful to consumers, and messaging and branding consistency - a proven IMC concept - yield customer satisfaction and loyalty. An approach to achieving the objective of a marketing campaign through a well coordinated use of different promotional methods that are intended to reinforce each other. As defined by the American Association of Advertising Agencies – IMC recognizes the value of a comprehensive plan that evaluates the strategic roles of a variety of communication discipline Advertising, public relations, personal selling and sales promotion and combines them to provide Clarity, consistency and maximum communication profit.

COMMUNICATION OBJECTIVE

- To develop brand awareness
- To increase consumer or business demand for a product category

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- To change or influence customer beliefs or attitudes
- To enhance purchase actions
- To encourage repeat purchases
- To build customer traffic to physical stores, websites or other marketing channels
- To enhance firm/brand image
- To increase market share
- To increase sales
- To reinforce purchase decision

STEPS IN DEVELOPING EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION:

1. **Identify the target audience** - A major part of audience analysis is assessing the audience's current image of the company, its products, and its competitors. If most respondents have unfavorable feelings towards the product, the organization needs to overcome a negative image problem, which requires great patience because images are persistent even long after the organization has changed. Once people have a certain image, they perceive what is consistent with that image. It will take highly disconfirming information to raise doubts and open their minds- but it can be done.
2. **Determine the communication objectives** - Here the marketer wants to decide that whether he wants to put something into consumer's mind, change an attitude, or get the consumer to act. "Learn-feel-do" sequence is appropriate when the audience has high involvements with a product category that is perceived to have differentiation, as in purchasing an automobile. An alternative sequence, "do-feel-learn," is relevant when the audience has high involvement but perceive little or no differentiation within the product category, as in purchasing aluminum siding. A third sequence, "learn-do-feel," is relevant when the audience has low involvement and perceives little differentiation within the category, as in purchasing salt.
3. **Design the message** - The communicator now moves next to developing an effective message. Ideally, the message should gain attention, hold interest, arouse desire, and elicit action. AIDA (Attention- Interest-Desire-Action) framework suggests the desirable qualities of any communication. Formulating the message involves decisions about message content, structure, format, and source.
4. **Select the communication channels** - The communicator must select an effective communication channel to carry the message. In general, firms use two types of

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communication channels: personal and non-personal. Personal communication channels involve two or more persons communicating directly with each other face to face, person to audience, over the telephone, or through e-mail. These channels derive their effectiveness through individualized presentation and feedback. Non-personal communication channels include media, atmospheres, and events. Media consists of print media, broadcast media, network media, electronic media, and display media. Most non-personal messages come through paid media. Atmospheres are “packaged environments” that create or reinforce the buyer’s learning’s toward product purchase. Law offices, for instance, are decorated with fine rugs and furniture to communicate “stability” and “success”. Events are occurrences such as news conferences, grand opening, and other activities designed to communicate particular message to target audiences.

5. **Establish the communications budget** - Industries and companies vary considerably in how much they spend on promotion. Expenditures might amount to 30- 50 percent of sales in the cosmetics industry but only 5-10 percent in the industrial-equipment industry, with company to company variations. Four common methods of deciding on a budget include: Affordable method: Many companies set the promotion budget at what management thinks the firm can afford. Percentage-of-the-sales method: Many firms set promotion expenditure as a specified percentage of sales or of the sales price.
6. **Decide on the media mix i.e. Marketing Communication Mix** - Companies must decide how to allocate the budget over the five promotional tools. Even in the same industry, companies differ considerably in their media and channel choices. Advertising can reach geographically dispersed buyers efficiently. Certain forms of advertising require a large budget, while others do not. Sales promotion tools coupons, contests, premiums and the like offer three key benefits: communication, incentive and invitation. The appeal of public relations and publicity is based on three qualities: high credibility, ability to catch buyers off guard and dramatization. Direct marketing can be in the form of direct mail, telemarketing and Internet Marketing. These share four characteristics- nonpublic, customized, up-to-date and interactive. Qualities of personal selling include personal confrontation, cultivation and response.
7. **Measure the results** - After implementing the promotional plan, the company must measure its impact. Members of the target audience are asked whether they recognize or recall the message, how many times they saw it, what points they recall, how they felt about the message, and their previous and current attitude towards the product and company. The communicator should also collect behavioral measures of audience response, such as how many people bought the product, like it, and talked to others about it.

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- 8. Manage the integrated marketing communication process** - Given the fragmenting of mass markets, the proliferation of new media, and the growing sophistication of customers, companies need to use a wider range of tools and messages through integrated marketing communications. Integrated marketing communications (IMC) is a concept of marketing communications planning that recognizes the added value of a comprehensive plan evaluating the strategic roles of a variety of communications disciplines-such as advertising, direct response, sales promotion and public relations- and combine these disciplines to provide clarity, consistence and maximum communications impact through the seamless integration of discrete messages. Properly implemented, IMC improves the firm's ability to reach the right customers with the right messages at the right time and in the right place

STAGES IN DESIGNING MESSAGE:

1. Sender: The party or person who is sending the message to the other party or person is the sender.
2. Encoding: The conversion of thought into the meaningful symbols is called encoding.
3. Message: The group of symbols transmitted by the sender is called a message.
4. Media: The channel of communication through which transfers the message from sender to receiver is called media.
5. Decoding: The conversion of symbols into meaning by the receiver is called decoding.
6. Receiver: The sent message received by another person or party is called the receiver.
7. Response: The reaction shown by the receiver before the message is called response.
8. Feed Back: The portion of the response of the receiver that is sent back to the sender is called feedback.

ADVERTISING MEANING

Advertising is a paid form of non personal communication. Advertising promotes ideas, goods and services of identified sponsors. The main purpose of advertising is to create sales. Advertising is a marketing tactic involving paying for space to promote a product, service, or cause. The actual promotional messages are called advertisements, or ads for short. The goal of advertising is to reach people most likely to be willing to pay for a company's products or services and entice them to buy.

ADVERTISING OBJECTIVES

1. To Inform - Advertisements are used to increase the brand awareness and brand exposure in the target market. Informing the potential customers about the brand and its products is the first step towards attaining business goals.
2. To Persuade - Persuading customers to perform a particular task is a prominent objective of advertising. The tasks may involve buying or trying the products and services offered, to from

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a brand image, develop a favorable attitude towards the brand etc.

3. To Remind - Another objective of advertising is to reinforce the brand message and to reassure the existing and potential customers about the brand vision. Advertising helps the brand to maintain top of mind awareness and to avoid competitors stealing the customers. This also helps in the word of mouth marketing.
4. Introduce a product - The most common reason Advertising is used is to introduce a new product in the market. This can be done by existing brands as well as new brands. Have a look at the latest iPhone in the market or a Samsung smartphone and you will find a lot of advertisement for these new products. The objective of advertising here is to tell customers – “Here is the new product we have launched”.
5. Introduce a brand - There are many startups in the market today and many of them are services. Services are generally marketed as a brand rather than marketing their individual service product. Thus, Uber will market its own brand and introduce that Uber has started servicing customers in a new market. Same goes for Oracle or Accenture – Companies which market their brand and their presence in the market rather than marketing an individual product.
6. Differentiation and value creation - A most important aspect of Advertising is to differentiate the product or the service from those of the competitor. A customer can only differentiate between services based on the value the firms provides over that of competitors.
7. Acquiring customers or Brand switching - One of the major objectives of advertising and the first objective of many advertising campaigns is to acquire more customers. This is also known as making the customers switch brands. This can happen by passing on a strong message so that the potential customer leaves the brand which he is tied up with and comes to your brand.
8. Brand building - When a brand regularly advertises and delivers quality products and fulfills the promises it makes, automatically the value of the brand is built. However, there are many other aspects of brand building. One of the first ones is to advertise via ATL and BTL campaigns etc.
9. Increase sales - Naturally, with so many steps being taken to advertise the product, it is no doubt that one of the objectives of advertising is to increase sales. Many a times this objective is achieved via advertising. However, if the campaign is improper or the audience is not targeted properly, then advertising can fail in its objective.

ADVERTISING BUDGET

An advertising budget is estimate of a company's promotional expenditures over a certain period of time. More pertinently, it is the money a company is willing to set aside to accomplish its marketing objectives. When creating the advertising budget, a company must weigh the tradeoffs between spending one additional advertising dollar with the amount of revenue that dollar will bring in as revenue.

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The advertising budget of a business is typically a subset of the larger sales budget and, within that, the marketing budget.

METHODS / TYPES OF ADVERTISING BUDGET:

Advertising is a part of the sales and marketing effort. Money spent on advertising can also be seen as an investment in building up the business.

1. Percentage of Sales method
2. Objective and Task method
3. Competitive Parity method
4. Market Share method
5. Unit Sales method
6. All Available Funds method
7. Affordable method

It is important to notice that most of these methods are often combined in any number of ways, depending on the situation. Because of this, these methods should not be seen as rigid but as building blocks that can be combined, modified, or discarded as necessary. Remember, a business must be flexible—ready to change course, goals, and philosophy when the market and the consumer demand such a change.

1. Percentage of Sales Method

Due to its simplicity, the percentage of sales method is the most commonly used by small businesses. When using this method an advertiser takes a percentage of either past or anticipated sales and allocates that percentage of the overall budget to advertising. But critics of this method charge that using past sales for figuring the advertising budget is too conservative, that it can stunt growth. However, it might be safer for a small business to use this method if the ownership feels that future returns cannot be safely anticipated. On the other hand, an established business, with well-established profit trends, will tend to use anticipated sales when figuring advertising expenditures. This method can be especially effective if the business compares its sales with those of the competition (if available) when figuring its budget.

2. Objective and Task Method

Because of the importance of objectives in business, the task and objective method is considered by many to make the most sense and is therefore used by most large businesses. The benefit of this method is that it allows the advertiser to correlate advertising expenditures with overall marketing objectives. This correlation is important because it keeps spending focused on primary business goals.

With this method, a business needs to first establish concrete marketing objectives, often

articulated in the "selling proposal," and then develop complementary advertising objectives articulated in the "positioning statement." After these objectives have been established, the advertiser determines how much it will cost to meet them. Of course, fiscal realities need to be figured into this methodology as well. Some objectives (expansion of area market share by 15 percent within a year, for instance) may only be reachable through advertising expenditures beyond the capacity of a small business. In such cases, small business owners must scale down their objectives so that they reflect the financial situation under which they are operating.

3. Competitive Parity Method

While keeping one's own objectives in mind, it is often useful for a business to compare its advertising spending with that of its competitors. The theory here is that if a business is aware of how much its competitors are spending to advertise their products and services, the business may wish to budget a similar amount on its own advertising by way of staying competitive. Doing as one's competitor does is not, of course, always the wisest course. And matching another's advertising budget dollar for dollar does not necessarily buy one the same marketing outcome. Much depends on how that money is spent. However, gauging one's advertising budget on other participants' in the same market is a reasonable starting point.

4. Market Share Method

Similar to competitive parity, the market share method bases its budgeting strategy on external market trends. With this method a business equates its market share with its advertising expenditures. Critics of this method contend that companies that use market share numbers to arrive at an advertising budget are ultimately predicating their advertising on an arbitrary guideline that does not adequately reflect future goals.

5. Unit Sales Method

This method takes the cost of advertising an individual item and multiplies it by the number of units the business wishes to sell. This method is only effective, of course, when the cost of advertising a single unit can be reasonably determined.

6. All Available Funds Method

This aggressive method involves the allocation of all available profits to advertising purposes. This can be risky for a business of any size it means that no money is being used to help the business grow in other ways (purchasing new technologies, expanding the work force, etc.). Yet this aggressive approach is sometimes useful when a start-up business is trying to increase consumer awareness of its products or services. However, a business using this approach needs to make sure that its advertising strategy is an effective one and that funds which could help the business expand are not being wasted.

7. Affordable Method

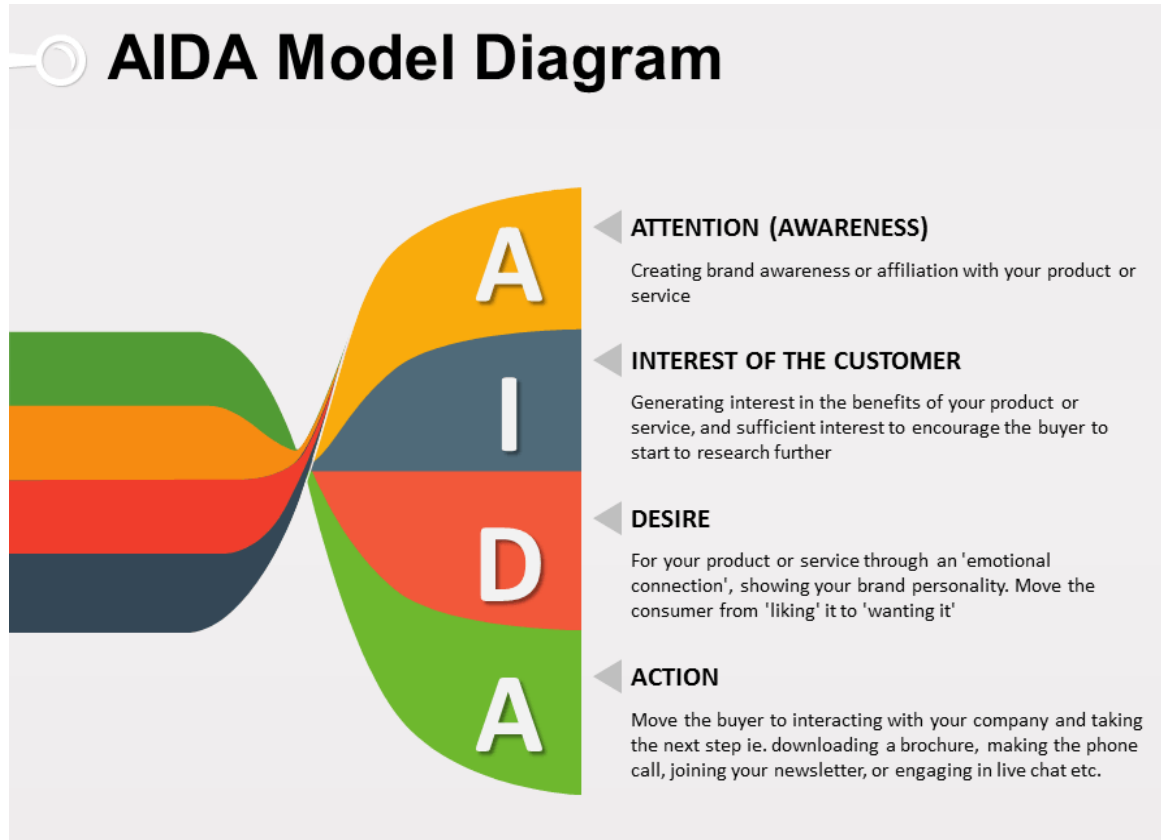
With this method, advertisers base their budgets on what they can afford. Of course, arriving at a conclusion about what a small business can afford in the realm of advertising is often a difficult task, one that needs to incorporate overall objectives and goals, competition, presence in the market, unit sales, sales trends, operating costs, and other factors.

ADVERTISING COPY

An advertising copy is a term used to describe the main text used in the advertisement. The text could be a dialogue, a catchy punch line or a company's dictum. It is a print, radio or TV advertising message that aims at developing and retaining an interest of the target customer and prompting him to purchase the product within a couple of seconds. An advertisement copy is the text used in the advertisement, be it print, radio, television or other form of advertisement. The text so used can be in the form of dialogs, some catchy phrase, a company's motto or slogan or any word.

AIDA MODEL

- ❖ AIDA is an acronym that stands for Attention, Interest, Desire and Action. The AIDA model is widely used in marketing and advertising to describe the steps or stages that occur from the time when a consumer first becomes aware of a product or brand through to when the consumer trials a product or makes a purchase decision. Given that many consumers become aware of brands via advertising or marketing communications, the AIDA model helps to explain how an advertisement or marketing communications message engages and involves consumers in brand choice.
- ❖ In essence, the AIDA model proposes that advertising messages need to accomplish a number of tasks in order to move the consumer through a series of sequential steps from brand awareness through to action (purchase and consumption).
- ❖ The AIDA model is one of the longest serving models used in advertising, having been developed in the late nineteenth century. Since its first appearance in the marketing and advertising literature, the model has been modified and expanded to account for the advent of new advertising media and communications platforms. A number of modified alternative models are in current use. During the past 100 years, the model has undergone many refinements and extensions, such that today there are many variants in circulation. Thus, the simple AIDA model is now one of a class of models, collectively known as hierarchical models or hierarchy of effects models.



First Step: Attention

Often, the attention part is overlooked by many marketers. It is assumed that the product or service already got the attention of the consumers – which may or may not be the case. In any event, don't just assume that everyone is already aware of your product. One of the best approaches to attracting consumer attention is what's called "creative disruption" – breaking existing patterns of behavior through a highly creative message. This can be done in several ways:

- Placing advertisements in unexpected situations or locations. This is often referred to as guerrilla marketing.
- Creating shock in advertisements through provocative imagery.
- An intensely targeted message. This is also referred to as personalization. Essentially, the goal is to make consumers aware that a product or service exists.

Second Step: Interest

Creating interest is generally the hardest part. For example, if the product or service is not inherently interesting, this can be very difficult to achieve. Make sure that advertising information is broken up and easy to read, with interesting subheadings and illustrations. Focus on what is most relevant for your target market in relation to your product or service, and on conveying only the most important message you want to communicate to consumers. A good example of this is Wendy's "Where's the beef?" ad campaign that focused on the fact that Wendy's hamburgers contained more beef than their competitors' hamburgers.

Third Step: Desire

The second and third steps of the AIDA model go together. As you are hopefully building interest in a product or service, it is important that you help customers realize why they “need” this product or service. Think about how the content in infomercials is presented – they aim to provide interesting information on the product, along with benefits of buying it – benefits that ideally make consumers want the product more and more. Infomercials do this extremely well by showing the product being used in several creative situations. Convey to the audience the value of the product or service, and why they need it in their life.

Fourth Step: Action

The last step of the AIDA model is getting your consumer to initiate action. The advertisement should end with a call to action – a statement that is designed to get an immediate response from the consumer. For example, Netflix uses persuasive text to convince the consumer to try their free trial. Netflix communicates how convenient their product is and highlights its value, then urges consumers to sign up for a free trial.

Good advertising should elicit a sense of urgency that motivates consumers to take action RIGHT NOW. One commonly used method for achieving this goal is making limited time offers (such as: free shipping).

TRADITIONAL MEDIA

The non-electronic mediums which works as part of our culture and as vehicles of transmitting tradition from one generation to another generation is called traditional media. The different forms of traditional media are as follows: Traditional dance • drama • painting • sculpture • song • music • motifs and symbols • Street Play • Games

MODERN MEDIA

New media are forms of media that are native to computers, computational and relying on computers for redistribution. Some examples of new media are telephones, computers, virtual worlds, single media, website games, human-computer interface, computer animation and interactive computer installations. New media are often contrasted to "old media", such as television, radio, and print media, although scholars in communication and media studies have criticized rigid distinctions based on oldness and novelty. New media does not include television programs (only analog broadcast), feature films, magazines, books, – unless they contain technologies that enable digital generative or interactive processes The different forms of modern media are as follows: Digital Video • Digital Sound • Graphics • Animation

ONLINE ADVERTISING

Online advertising, also called online marketing or Internet advertising or web advertising is

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a form of marketing and advertising which uses the Internet to deliver promotional marketing messages to consumers. It includes email marketing, search engine marketing (SEM), social media marketing, many types of display advertising (including web banner advertising) Online advertising is a marketing strategy that involves the use of the Internet as a medium to obtain website traffic and target and deliver marketing messages to the right customers. Online advertising is geared toward defining markets through unique and useful applications. Since the early 1990s there has been an exponential increase in the growth of online advertising, which has evolved into a standard for small and large organizations. Online advertising is also known as Internet advertising or Digital Advertising.

MOBILE ADVERTISING

Mobile advertising is the communication of products or services to mobile device and Smartphone consumers. The mobile advertising spectrum ranges from short message service (SMS) text to interactive advertisements. Mobile advertising is type of advertising that appears on mobile devices such as smart phones and tablets that have wireless connections. As a subset of mobile marketing, mobile advertising can take place as text ads via SMS, or banner advertisements that appear embedded in mobile web site, in downloaded apps or in mobile games. Mobile technology used by companies such as Google and Face book tailor mobile advertisements based on individual's web browsing history, geographic location, and with data collected by shopping habits. Because mobile devices typically have smaller screens than computers or laptops, this form of digital advertising is usually optimized for small displays by being concise.

SOCIAL MEDIA FOR ADVERTISING

Social network advertising, also social media targeting, is a group of terms that are used to describe forms of online advertising that focus on social networking services. One of the major benefits of this type of advertising is that advertisers can take advantage of the users' demographic information and target their ads appropriately. Social media targeting combines current targeting options (such as geotargeting, behavioral targeting, socio-psychographic targeting, etc.), to make detailed group identification possible. With social media targeting, advertisements are distributed to users based on information gathered from target group profiles. Social network advertising is not necessarily the same as social media targeting. Social media targeting is a method of optimizing social media advertising by using profile data to deliver advertisements directly to individual users. Social media targeting refers to the process of matching social network users to target groups that have been specified by the advertiser.

KEY COMPONENTS OF DIGITAL MARKETING:

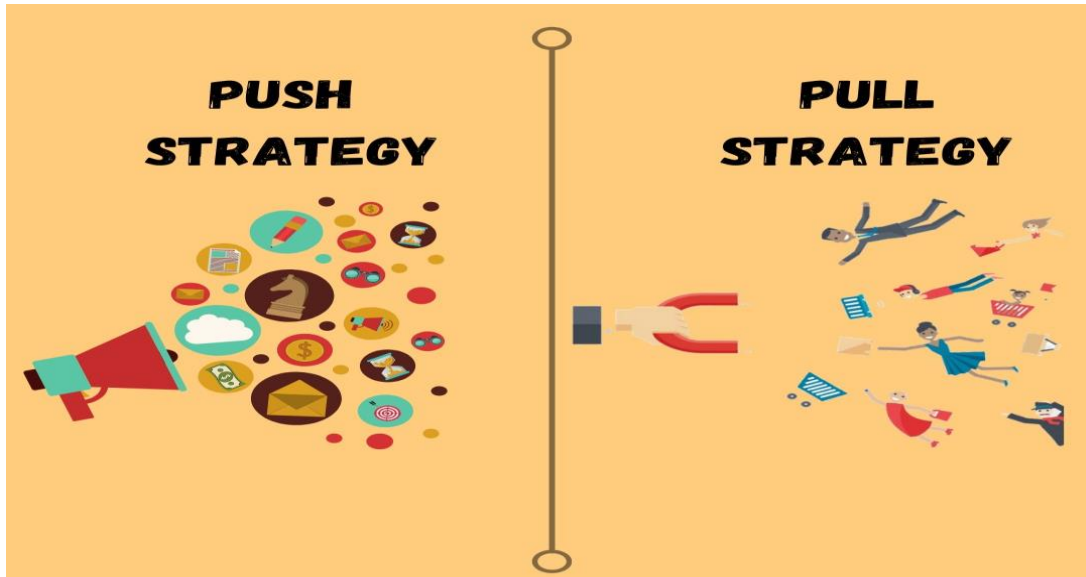
Digital marketing is the practice of promoting products or services through digital channels. Here are some key components of digital marketing:

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1. **Search engine optimization (SEO):** This involves optimizing a website to rank higher in search engine results pages (SERPs) for relevant keywords. SEO involves both on-page and off-page optimization strategies to increase organic traffic and visibility.
2. **Pay-per-click (PPC) advertising:** This is a form of online advertising where advertisers pay each time a user clicks on their ad. PPC advertising can be done through search engines (e.g., Google Ads) or social media platforms (e.g., Facebook Ads).
3. **Social media marketing:** This involves using social media platforms (e.g., Facebook, Twitter, Instagram) to promote products or services and engage with customers. Social media marketing can include both organic and paid efforts.
4. **Content marketing:** This involves creating and sharing valuable content (e.g., blog posts, videos, infographics) to attract and engage a target audience. Content marketing can be used to drive traffic, generate leads, and build brand awareness.
5. **Email marketing:** This involves using email to communicate with customers and prospects. Email marketing can be used to promote products or services, nurture leads, and build relationships with customers.
6. **Mobile marketing:** This involves reaching customers through mobile devices, such as smartphones and tablets. Mobile marketing can include tactics such as mobile apps, mobile-optimized websites, and SMS marketing.
7. **Analytics and reporting:** Digital marketing efforts should be tracked and measured to assess their effectiveness. Analytics tools can provide insights into website traffic, user behavior, and campaign performance.

These are just a few of the key components of digital marketing. The digital marketing landscape is constantly evolving, so it's important for businesses to stay up-to-date with the latest trends and best practices in order to effectively reach and engage their target audience.

PUSH AND PULL STRATEGIES:



Promotion is an important part of any marketing strategy. You can have the best product or service out there, but unless you promote it successfully, no one will know about it. There are three basic types of promotional strategies – a push strategy, a pull strategy or a combination of the two. In general, a push strategy is sales oriented, a pull strategy is marketing-oriented and a push-pull strategy is a combination of the two.

Push Promotional Strategy

A push promotional strategy works to create customer demand for your product or service through promotion: for example, through discounts to retailers and trade promotions. Appealing package design and maintaining a reputation for reliability, value or style are also used in push strategies. One example of a push strategy is mobile phone sales, where manufacturers offer discounts on phones to encourage buyers to choose their phone. Push promotional strategies also focus on selling directly to customers, for example, through point of sale displays and direct approaches to customers.

- A push strategy involves actively promoting a product or service to retailers, wholesalers, and distributors, who then push it out to consumers through advertising, discounts, or other promotions. The goal of a push strategy is to increase demand by increasing the availability of a product or service.

These are the most common push promotion strategies used today:

- ❖ Direct selling to customers in showrooms
- ❖ Point of Sale (POS) displays
- ❖ Trade show promotions
- ❖ Package or display design

Advantages of Push Marketing Strategy

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There are many advantages to using a push marketing strategy including:

- ❖ The ability to establish a sales channel
- ❖ Create product exposure, demand, and consumer awareness about a product
- ❖ Able to forecast and predict demand

Pull Promotional Strategy

A pull promotional strategy uses advertising to build up customer demand for a product or service. For example, advertising children's toys on children's television shows is a pull strategy. The children ask their parents for the toys, the parents ask the retailers and the retailers order the toys from the manufacturer. Other pull strategies include sales promotions, offering discounts or two-for-one offers and building demand through social media sites such as YouTube.

- A pull promotional strategy also called a pull marketing strategy, is the opposite of a push strategy. Instead of directly attempting to get products in front of customers, a pull strategy aims to get the customers to come to the product (hence the term “pull”).
- A pull strategy is all about getting the customer to come to you. There are six widely used pull marketing strategies employed today:
 - ❖ Advertising and mass media production
 - ❖ Word-of-mouth referrals
 - ❖ Customer relationship management
 - ❖ Sales promotions and discounts
 - ❖ Social media coverage
 - ❖ Email marketing

Advantages of Pull Marketing Strategy

There are many advantages of using a pull marketing strategy, including:

- ❖ Establishing direct contact with your customers
- ❖ Building consumer loyalty
- ❖ Stronger bargaining power with retailers or distributors
- ❖ No pressure to conduct outbound marketing
- ❖ Ability to test a product's acceptance in the market and gain feedback on the product

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Combination of Both Strategies

Some companies use a combination of both push and pull strategies. For example, Texas-based textile producer Cotton Incorporated uses a push/pull promotional strategy. They push to create customer demand through constantly developing new products and offering these products in stores; and pull customers towards these products through advertising and promotion deals.

According to marketing expert Blair Entenmann, in an article he wrote for his company Marketing Help, there is no single correct combination of push and pull. The amount spent on each type of strategy will depend on factors such as budget, the type of product, the target audience and competition.

When To Use Each Strategy

Push promotional strategies work well for lower cost items, or items where customers may make a decision on the spot. New businesses use push strategies to develop retail markets for their products and to generate exposure. Once a product is already in stores, a pull strategy creates additional demand for the product. Pull strategies work well with highly visible brands, or where there is good brand awareness. This is usually developed through advertising.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS:

1. Briefly explain the channel design decisions.7m
2. What is Channel conflict? Identify the causes of Channel conflict. 7m
3. Explain the factors effecting the channel choice.10m
4. What are the elements involved in designing physical distribution system? 7m
5. Explain the channels available for the distribution of consumer goods.10m
6. Explain AIDA concept of message development.7m
7. Define Direct Marketing.3m
8. Define IMC.3m
9. What is channel conflict? Explain the types of channel conflict.7m

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- 10. Explain the steps in effective communication.10m**
- 11. Explain Advertising, its objectives & Different media involved in the advertising.10m**
- 12. Discuss the methods need for preparing advertising budget.10m**
- 13. Compare the push and pull marketing strategies with appropriate examples.7m**
- 14. Compose the procedure of Market Channel Designing.7m**
- 15. Accumulate & Analyze the key components of Digital Marketing.10m**
- 16. State the different levels of channel.3m**
- 17. Enumerate the steps involved in physical distribution system.7m**
- 18. List out the stages in designing message.7m**

